

disk > Click Use Backup Disk. You will be notified when your backup is complete. If using your external drive as a backup for the first time, ensure that it is formatted or partitioned properly.

Leveraging its ability to backup both your files and system preferences, Time machine goes a step further and saves modified files separately. This allows you to restore your Mac and everything in it to the way it looked on a given day and time in the past, while retaining all the files from other times, in case you still need them. Time Machine allows you to encrypt your backup to make it more secure. Furthermore, it mostly works in the background while you work, so you do not have to set yourself reminders to backup your data. However, Time Machine can only backup to drives formatted in Mac OS Extended (Journaled) or HFS format. It does not recognise NTFS or FAT formats, which is what Windows compatible drives or flash drives use. You could reformat or partition your NTFS/FAT drive to enable it to backup your Mac's data.

Requirements

Mac OS X 10.5 Leopard or later.

Price

Free.

2. AirPort Time Capsule

The AirPort Time Capsule is a device that is built to work automatically with Time Machine, and works pretty much like any other external drive, with one exception – it is wireless.



AirPort Time Capsule holds up to 3 TB of data.

Like the two other Apple products from the same family - AirPort Express and AirPort Extreme, it also functions as a Wi-Fi router, offering dual bandwidth (2.4 GHz and 5 GHz) and 108.11ac. But while the other two devices are merely Wi-Fi routers, AirPort Time Capsule serves as both a router and a storage device. It comes with wired support if that is what you prefer using.

What does it back up?

It backs up the same data that any other drive does with Time Machine